

II ①<sup>⑧</sup> The **supposed**<sup>①</sup> importance of influentials derives from <sup>②</sup> a **plausible**<sup>②</sup>-sounding but largely untested theory called the “two-step flow of communication”: Information flows from the media to the influentials and from them to everyone else. ② Marketers have **embraced**<sup>③</sup> the two-step flow because it suggests that if they can just find and influence the influentials, those **select**<sup>④</sup> people will do most of the work for them. ③ The theory also seems to explain the sudden and unexpected popularity of certain looks, brands, or neighborhoods. ④ In many such cases, a **cursory**<sup>⑤</sup> search for causes finds that some small group of people was wearing, promoting, or developing whatever it is before anyone else paid attention. ⑤ **Anecdotal**<sup>⑥</sup> evidence of this kind fits nicely with the idea that only certain special people can drive trends.

有影响力人士的所谓重要性源于一个貌似合理、但很大程度上未经证实的被称为“两级流动传播”的理论：信息从媒体流向有影响力人士，再从他们流向其他所有人。营销人员已经欣然接受这种两级流动，因为该理论认为，他们只要能够找到有影响力人士并对其施加影响，这些精挑细选出来的人们就可以为他们完成大部分工作。该理论似乎也解释了某些时式、品牌或地段突然出人意料地大受欢迎的原因。在诸多此类情形中，粗略调查其原因会发现，的确有一小部分人在其他所有人留意之前，就率先穿戴、推广或开发各类东西。这种轶事证据与“只有某些特别的人才能推动潮流”的观点高度契合。

### · 词汇注释与难句分析 ·



- ① **supposed** [sə'pəʊzd] *a.* 误以为的；误信的；所谓的  
 ② **plausible** ['plɔ:zəbəl] *a.* (借口或解释)有道理的  
 ③ **embrace** [ɪm'breɪs] *v.* 乐意采纳(建议等)  
 ④ **select** [sɪ'lekt] *a.* 精选的；优等的  
 ⑤ **cursory** ['kʌsəri] *a.* 粗略的；仓促的  
 ⑥ **anecdotal** [ˈænikdəʊtl] *a.* 轶事的；趣闻的；传闻的

### ● 经典搭配

- ① derive from(起源于)  
 ② flow from... to... (从……流向……)  
 ③ in many such cases(在诸多此类情形中)  
 ④ a cursory search(粗略调查)  
 ⑤ pay attention(to)(关注，留心)  
 ⑥ anecdotal evidence(轶事证据)  
 ⑦ fit nicely with(与……高度契合)

### · 语篇分析 ·



第二段指出 Gladwell 观点所依理论：两级流动传播。关键词：a plausible-sounding but largely untested theory/two-step flow of communication.

①句指出 Gladwell 观点的理论来源“两级流动理论”，并予以总体评判“貌似合理却未经证实”。主句先以 The supposed importance of influentials 回指上文 Gladwell 观点(supposed 意为“误以为的，所谓的”，再次表明作者否定态度)；再以 derives from(源自，源于)引出该观点的理论来源——两级流动传播(本文另一关键词)；最后以两个 from... to... 结构解释“两级”所指、契合 Gladwell 观点：媒体→有影响力人士→其他所有人，即：有影响力人士起着“将信息直接散播给大众(引发社会流行潮)”的巨大作用。

句中 theory 的修饰评定成分 plausible-sounding, but largely untested 回应上段②句及本句 supposed 对 Gladwell 观点的评判，完整表明作者批驳态度，其批驳逻辑基本设定：先退步说明 Gladwell 观点及两级流动理论的貌似合理性——后集中用切实证据将其推翻。

②③④⑤句借指出营销者热衷两级流动理论的原因，侧面说明其貌似合理性。Marketers have embraced the two-step flow because it suggests... The theory also seems to... 将因果关联跨越整个句群，并在②句原因和③④⑤句原因之间以并列之形传达递进之意。

②句指出该理论受到营销者追捧，并从“理论本身”角度说明原因：它似乎可被用作理想的营销方法。主句借 embrace 描绘“张开双手拥抱”的画面，形象说明营销人员对该理论的“欣然接受”。because 从句以 if... will... (“一……就……”，只要某一条件具备，某事自然便会发生)、just(只需)、most of(绝